

Canadian teenager and her favourite cow win a top dairy prize

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Some competitions have tennis rackets. This one has cows! At the World **Dairy** Expo in Madison, Wisconsin, a Canadian teenager celebrated a big win with her favourite cow on Sunday.

Alyson Doiron is a 16-year-old high school student from Cap-Santé in Quebec. Her favourite cow, Arolene Dempsey Ella, is usually called Ella. The five-year-old cow won the top prize at the International Junior Holstein Show. Holstein is a **breed**, or type, of **dairy** cow.

Doiron cheered and cried when she accepted the honour for Ella. She said the cow is easy to work with and much loved. The prize mattered to her, and she felt it showed the strength of cow showing in Quebec.

The Expo brings together people from around the world. However, health and safety rules mean the animals competing come from Canadian and American farms.

A major win can increase a cow's **value** by tens of thousands of dollars. It can also make the cow's future **calves** more valuable.

Getting there takes planning. Brian Carscadden and his team from a Quebec **dairy** company drove more than 1,500 kilometres with 25 cows in **trailers**.

The event took place during a trade **dispute** between Canada and the United States. Carscadden said his business had not been affected yet and that the **dispute** did not come up often in conversations at the Expo.

Word Treasure

breed -- A type of animal within the same animal group.

dairy -- Related to milk and its production.

calves -- Young cows.

value -- How much something is worth.

trailers -- Vehicles pulled behind another vehicle to carry things or animals.

dispute -- A disagreement.

Background you need

A dairy cow is kept for milk production.

A breed is a type of animal; Holstein is a breed of dairy cow.

Break it down

Introduces the Canadian teenager and Ella's win in Wisconsin.

Explains Ella's breed and Doiron's reaction.

Describes competition rules and the possible value of a win.

Ends with travel preparations and Carscadden's account of the trade dispute.

Why it matters

The story shows a teenager taking part in a farming competition and explains how a prize can affect a cow's value.

Test what you remember

1. Where did Ella win her prize?

- ☐ (A) Madison, Wisconsin
- ☐ (B) Toronto, Ontario
- ☐ (C) Cap-Santé, Quebec
- ☐ (D) Boston, Massachusetts

2. How old is Alyson Doiron?

- ☐ (A) Sixteen years old
- ☐ (B) Eighteen years old
- ☐ (C) Fourteen years old
- ☐ (D) Twenty years old

3. Which prize did Ella win?

- ☐ (A) The top farm planning prize
- ☐ (B) The top cow transport prize
- ☐ (C) The top junior Holstein prize
- ☐ (D) The top dairy company prize

4. How did Doiron describe Ella?

- ☐ (A) Hard to travel with
- ☐ (B) Easy to work with
- ☐ (C) Quick to run away
- ☐ (D) Slow to learn tasks

5. Why do competing animals come only from Canadian and American farms?

- ☐ (A) Because of health and safety rules
- ☐ (B) Because of weather and road conditions
- ☐ (C) Because of distance and travel costs
- ☐ (D) Because of space and trailer sizes

6. What can a major win do for a cow?

- ☐ (A) Change its breed
- ☐ (B) Reduce its age
- ☐ (C) Shorten its name
- ☐ (D) Increase its value

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: C 4: B 5: A 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Alyson Doiron: She described Ella as easy to work with and much loved, and felt the win showed the strength of cow showing in Quebec.
2. Brian Carscadden: He said his business had not yet been affected by the trade dispute and that it rarely came up in Expo conversations.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):